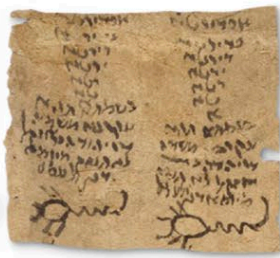




▲ **The frog** was a symbol of fertility because of its many offspring. Frog ornaments like this ancient Egyptian one were kept by women hoping for an easy childbirth and rebirth in the afterlife.



▲ **Scorpion papers** were a medieval Jewish magical charm. A rough sketch of a scorpion, together with a few words, could be rolled up and hung around the neck as a protective amulet.



▲ **Zuni carvings** were animal-shaped fetishes of the ancient Zuni people of New Mexico. They carried such objects for luck and to protect them from danger when they went out hunting.

"Windows" are worked into the gold

The pinnacle is shaped like a cathedral in miniature



▲ **Scarab beetle** amulets were laid on the heart (the only organ preserved) of a mummified dead person in ancient Egypt. The scarab was believed to ease the journey to the afterlife.



▲ **Ganesh** is the elephant-headed Hindu god of good fortune, still popular on amulets as he is believed to grant success to the wearer by removing material and spiritual obstacles.



▲ **The hagoday** (sanctuary knocker) on the door of a church guaranteed the right of asylum to anyone who knocked. Hagodays always had monstrous heads attached to heavy rings.



► **Christian relics** were the physical remains of saints, kept in a container. They were venerated objects, and early Christians would travel far to see them. Many were supposed to have miraculous healing powers. This object stood on a church altar while a mass was said in an attempt to stave off the plague.

The relic is a foot bone believed to belong to St. Sebastian



▲ **The eye of Horus**, also known as a *wedjat* pendant, was buried with ancient Egyptian pharaohs to protect them in the afterlife. Now such eyes are often known as *nazars*, from the Arabic word for sight or surveillance.



▲ **The hamsa** (also called the Hand of Fatima) warded off the evil eye and may have originated in ancient Egypt or in Carthage, where it was associated with the chief goddess, Tanit.